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HOUSING SUPPLY JUST HIT A TEN-YEAR HIGH.

4.9 months of inventory. NAR's own chief economist calls it the most leverage buyers have had in over a decade.

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1.62 MILLION HOMES ARE SITTING ON THE MARKET.

That's the first time inventory has topped 1.6 million since November 2019, per NAR's August 2026 report. Sales fell. The homes for sale didn't sell off with them.

SALES DROPPED. SUPPLY GREW ANYWAY.

NAR's August 2026 Existing-Home Sales report, released September 10, shows sales at a 3.98 million annual rate, down 1.2 percent from a year ago, while total inventory rose to 1.62 million units, up 5.9 percent year over year. That combination is what pushed months of supply to 4.9, the highest level in over ten years, according to NAR Chief Economist Lawrence Yun. The median home still sold in 31 days, unchanged from last year, and the median price still rose to \$429,100. Homes are not sitting because nobody wants them. They're sitting because buyers finally have somewhere else to look.

WHAT TO DO DIFFERENTLY WITH THIS MUCH SUPPLY ON THE MARKET:

- 1 Stop telling buyers to waive the inspection.**
At 4.9 months of supply, they don't need to
- 2 win a bidding war against six other offers that no longer exist.**
- 3 Ask for a closing cost credit before you ask for a price cut.**
Sellers facing this much
- 4 competing inventory often move faster on credits than on the number itself.**
- 5 Stop pricing a listing to "test the market."**
An overpriced home in a ten-year-high supply
- 6 environment sits, and every day it sits hands buyers more leverage to negotiate against you.**
- 7 Set sellers for a 31-day timeline, not a weekend bidding war.**
That's the actual median.
- 8 Coaching them to expect 2022 sets up a fight you'll have at the first low offer.**

THE TAKEAWAY

**THE MARKET GAVE
BUYERS LEVERAGE.
USE IT BEFORE THE
SELLER STOPS
OFFERING IT.**

Ask for what this market actually supports, not what worked three years ago.